controlled by the Carolingians who had spun a complex web of feudal duchies to suit their rule. Hugh Capet was declared king in 987 but he ruled only a limited kingdom.

Elsewhere in Europe, the Islamic forces laid siege to Constantinople. Byzantine struggled to hold them off and forced uneasy relationships with the kingdoms surrounding it. The empire established Orthodox Christianity, which was totally independent of some of the doctrines taught by the Church. The Byzantine Empire administered all matters that were religious in nature. It played an active role in developing creed and specific doctrines, which can be seen from Iconoclastic controversies that occurred in the middle of the ninth century.

During the 9th century, the Byzantine Empire suffered various hardships but in the 10th century, it experienced a revival. This occurred because the Muslims experienced a political chaos of their own. The Byzantine Empire was victorious over the Bulgars with the leadership of Basil II who reigned between 963 and 1025 CE. The armies gathered and descended upon the Islamic forces to recover both Cyprus and Crete. In 1054, the Byzantine Empire and Europe were finally divided between people who believed in Catholicism and those who favored the Orthodox faiths. The same year, the empire found itself in war with the tribes from modern day Turkey. Before there was any time to seek aid from the Church, the empire had fallen to these tribes.